

Word family: **ordinary / ordinarily / extraordinary**

Base word: ordinary

Related forms: ordinarily, extraordinary

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞)

Your sentence:

> “The ad showed **ordinary** people in stressful places.”

Meaning in this passage

Meaning: Normal, everyday people who are not presented as celebrities, experts, unusually wealthy people, or otherwise exceptional.

繁體中文: **一般日常生活中的普通人，沒有特殊身分、名氣或與眾不同的地位**

中文翻譯:

「那則廣告呈現了身處壓力環境中的**普通人／一般人**。」

ordinary people = 沒有特殊身分、名氣或突出地位的一般人

1. **ordinary = person/people (人物) not famous, powerful, or exceptional — 沒有特殊身分或突出地位的一般人**

Meaning: Describing normal members of the public rather than celebrities, leaders, experts, or other exceptional people.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The ad showed **ordinary** people in stressful places.”

「那則廣告呈現了身處壓力環境中的**一般普通人**。」

Practice 2

> “The documentary focuses on the lives of **ordinary** people.”

「這部紀錄片聚焦於**沒有特殊身分的一般人的日常生活**。」

Practice 3

> “The product was designed for **ordinary** consumers, not professional athletes.”

「這項產品是為**一般消費者**而設，而不是專業運動員。」

ordinary people = 社會中沒有特殊身分、名氣、權力或專業地位的一般人

2. **ordinary = object/event/day(事物／事件／日子) normal and not unusual or special — 普通正常、沒有特別之處的**

Meaning: Typical of what usually happens or exists; not unusual, special, or remarkable.

Practice 4

> “It started as an **ordinary** day.”

「那天一開始只是**和平常一樣、沒有甚麼特別的日子**。」

Practice 5

> “At first, the package looked completely **ordinary**.”

「乍看之下，那個包裝**很普通，沒有任何特別之處**。」

ordinary = 與平常情況相若、沒有異常或特別之處的

This is the broad core meaning behind **ordinary person**, but for MCQs it is useful to distinguish:

* **ordinary people** → 一般人，重點是**沒有特殊身分**

* **ordinary day/object** → 普通，重點是**沒有特別或異常之處**

3. **ordinary = quality/ability/performance(質素／能力／表現) not especially good or impressive — 平凡普通、沒有突出優點的**

Meaning: Of average or unremarkable quality; not especially impressive.

This often carries a mildly negative meaning.

Practice 6

> “The food was quite **ordinary**.”

「食物的質素**很一般，沒有甚麼令人印象深刻之處**。」

Practice 7

> “His first performance was fairly **ordinary**.”

「他第一次的表現**相當平凡**，沒有特別出色的地方。」

ordinary quality/performance = 水準一般、沒有明顯突出優點或令人印象深刻之處的

Important nuance:

> “an ordinary person”

is usually neutral.

But:

> “an ordinary meal”

can imply:

只是一般般，沒有甚麼特別好。

4. **ordinary** = usual/routine type (常規程序／通常種類) — 常規的; 日常通常採用的

Meaning: Belonging to the normal or standard way something is done, rather than a special procedure or arrangement.

Practice 8

> “The request can be handled through the **ordinary** procedure.”

「這項要求可以透過**一般常規程序**處理。」

Practice 9

> “These cases are dealt with during **ordinary** business hours.”

「這類個案會在**正常日常辦公時間**內處理。」

ordinary = 屬於平常、標準或常規安排，而不是特殊安排的

5. **out of the ordinary = noticeably unusual or different from normal — 不尋常; 異於平常**

This is a very common fixed expression.

Meaning: Unusual, unexpected, or different from what normally happens.

Practice 10

> “Did you notice anything **out of the ordinary**?”

「你有沒有注意到任何**異於平常、不尋常的情況**？」

Practice 11

> “Nothing **out of the ordinary** happened during the visit.”

「到訪期間沒有發生任何**不尋常或異常的事情**。」

out of the ordinary = 與平常情況明顯不同、令人覺得不尋常的

6. **ordinary shares(公司股份) — 一般股東持有、通常享有投票權及按公司表現收取股息的普通股**

This is an established British/Commonwealth finance meaning.

Meaning: The standard type of company shares, generally carrying voting rights and a claim on profits after higher-priority claims have been met.

Practice 12

> “He owns 2,000 **ordinary shares** in the company.”

「他持有該公司 2,000 股**普通股**。」

Practice 13

> “Holders of **ordinary shares** may receive dividends if the company makes a profit.”

「如果公司有盈利, **普通股股東**可能會獲派股息。」

ordinary shares = 公司最基本的一類股份, 股東通常享有投票權, 股息則視公司盈利而定

This does ****not**** mean the shares are boring or low-quality. ****Ordinary**** here identifies a financial category.

7. ****ordinary resolution** (公司決議) — 通常只需過半數票通過的一般公司決議******

This is an established corporate-law/business meaning, especially in UK/Hong Kong/Commonwealth English.

****Meaning:**** A company resolution normally passed by a simple majority of votes, rather than the higher threshold required for a special resolution.

Practice 14

> “The proposal was approved by an ****ordinary resolution****.”

「該提案透過****一般決議**，即通常只需過半數票通過的公司決議****獲批准。**」

Practice 15

> “An ****ordinary resolution**** is sufficient for this decision.”

「這項決定只需要通過****一般決議****即可。」

****ordinary resolution** = 公司治理中通常以簡單多數票便可通過的一類正式決議******

8. ****ordinary income** (一般收入／日常所得) — 按一般收入類別處理、而非資本增值等特殊類別的所得******

This is especially common in tax and finance contexts.

****Meaning:**** Income treated as regular income for tax purposes, rather than as capital gains or another specially classified form of income.

Practice 16

> “Salary is generally treated as ****ordinary income****.”

「薪金一般被視為****一般收入**，即按日常所得類別處理的收入****。**」

Practice 17

> “The tax treatment of ****ordinary income**** differs from that of capital gains.”

「****一般收入****與資本增值的稅務處理方式不同。」

****ordinary income = 在稅務或財務分類上屬於一般日常所得, 而非資本增值等特殊收入****

The exact legal treatment varies by jurisdiction, but the vocabulary sense is established.

9. ****ordinarily = normally / under usual circumstances — 通常; 在一般情況下****

****Meaning:**** In the normal course of events or under usual conditions.

Practice 18

> “The journey ****ordinarily**** takes about forty minutes.”

「在****一般正常情況下****, 這段路程大約需要四十分鐘。」

Practice 19

> “Visitors are ****ordinarily**** required to register at reception.”

「訪客在****通常情況下****都需要在接待處登記。」

****ordinarily = 按照平常情況或通常做法而言****

10. ****extraordinary = highly unusual / far beyond what is normal — 非比尋常; 極不一般****

This is the important opposite-related form.

****Meaning:**** Very unusual, remarkable, or far beyond what is normally expected.

Practice 20

> “She showed ****extraordinary**** patience.”

「她展現出****遠超一般程度、非常不尋常的耐性****。」

Practice 21

> “The team achieved an ****extraordinary**** result.”

「團隊取得了****遠超一般預期、非常出色的成果****。」

****extraordinary** = 明顯超出一般正常程度, 因而顯得非常不尋常或突出

11. ****extraordinary** = special/non-routine official situation (特別／非常規的正式安排) — 特別的; 非常規的

In formal institutional language, ****extraordinary**** can contrast with ****ordinary**** by meaning something convened or used outside the regular schedule.

Practice 22

> “The board called an ****extraordinary**** meeting.”

「董事會召開了一次****不屬於正常例會安排的特別會議****。」

Practice 23

> “An ****extraordinary**** session was held to deal with the emergency.”

「為處理緊急情況, 當局召開了一次****非常規的特別會議****。」

****extraordinary** = 因特殊情況而額外安排、並非日常常規的一類正式活動

Important distinction: ****ordinary** vs **normal**

They overlap strongly, but the emphasis can differ.

****ordinary****

Often emphasizes:

****not special / not exceptional****

> “an ordinary person”

= ****一般人, 沒有特殊身分****

****normal****

Often emphasizes:

****consistent with the expected or healthy state****

> “His temperature is normal.”

= ****他的體溫處於正常範圍****

Calling someone an ****ordinary person**** is natural.

Calling someone a ****normal person**** can sometimes imply contrast with someone “abnormal,” so the nuance is different.

Important distinction: **ordinary vs average**

**ordinary**

= not special or unusual

**average**

= typical based on a middle/statistical level, or only mediocre in quality

> “an average salary”

> = 接近一般統計水平的薪金

> “an ordinary salary”

> = 普通、沒有特別之處的薪金

They can overlap, but ****average**** has a stronger idea of comparison or statistical middle.

Important distinction: **ordinary vs common**

**ordinary**

= not special

**common**

= occurring frequently / existing in large numbers

For example:

> “It is a common problem.”

= 這個問題**很常見**。

> “It is an ordinary problem.”

= 這只是個**普通、沒有特殊之處的問題**。

A thing can be **ordinary** without necessarily being **common**, and vice versa.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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ordinary people	沒有特殊身分、名氣、權力或突出地位的一般人
ordinary object/day/event	與平常情況相若、沒有異常或特別之處的
ordinary quality/performance	水準一般、沒有明顯突出優點或令人印象深刻之處的
ordinary procedure/hours	屬於平常、標準或常規安排，而非特殊安排的
out of the ordinary	與平常情況明顯不同、令人覺得不尋常的
ordinary shares	公司最基本的一類普通股，通常附有一般股東權利
ordinary resolution	公司治理中通常只需簡單多數票通過的一般決議
ordinary income	在稅務／財務上屬於一般日常所得類別的收入
ordinarily	按照平常情況或通常做法而言
extraordinary — remarkable	明顯超出一般正常程度、非常不尋常或突出的
extraordinary — official	因特殊情況額外安排、並非日常常規的

For your original sentence

> “The ad showed **ordinary** people in stressful places.”

The exact meaning is:

ordinary = 沒有特殊身分、名氣、權力或突出地位的一般人

So:

ordinary people = 與一般觀眾相似、過著日常生活的普通人